

BUSINESS ANALYSIS PROJECT

E-Commerce Sales & Customer Analytics

Project Charter & Business Case

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Prepared By	Business Analyst
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Portfolio note: This is a simulated business case study created for demonstrating Business Analyst skills. It is not presented as employment or client-confidential work.

1. Document Control

Field	Details
Document ID	EC-BA-001
Project	E-Commerce Sales & Customer Analytics
Version	1.0
Initial Draft	09 January 2023
Baseline Date	13 January 2023
Project Sponsor	Director – E-Commerce
Business Owner	Head of Sales & Customer Growth
Business Analyst	Lead Business Analyst
Status	Baseline

2. Executive Summary

The e-commerce business has experienced inconsistent repeat purchasing, uneven regional performance, and increasing product returns. Management currently receives sales information from multiple operational reports, which makes it difficult to establish a single, trusted view of customer and sales performance.

The proposed initiative will define business and reporting requirements for an integrated Sales & Customer Analytics solution. The solution will consolidate agreed sales, order, customer, product, and return metrics into a standardized analytical model and management dashboard. The Business Analyst will lead requirements elicitation, process analysis, KPI definition, documentation, stakeholder validation, and UAT coordination.

The expected outcome is faster management reporting, improved visibility into customer behavior, better identification of retention opportunities, and more consistent decision-making across Sales, Marketing, Operations, and Finance.

3. Business Problem Statement

- Sales reports are maintained across multiple sources and are not consistently defined.
- Management lacks a common view of revenue, orders, customer activity, and returns.
- Regional and category-level underperformance is identified late.
- Customer segmentation is largely manual, limiting targeted retention campaigns.
- Return trends are not easily connected to product and customer performance.
- Analysts spend significant time preparing recurring reports instead of performing deeper analysis.

4. Business Drivers

- Increase repeat purchases and customer retention.
- Improve visibility of sales performance by region and product category.
- Reduce avoidable product returns through better trend analysis.
- Create standardized KPI definitions for management reporting.
- Reduce manual reporting effort and improve data accessibility.

- Provide a scalable foundation for future customer analytics.

5. Project Objectives

ID	Objective	Success Measure
OBJ-01	Standardize sales and customer KPIs.	Approved KPI catalogue used by business stakeholders.
OBJ-02	Provide management visibility into sales trends.	Dashboard supports monthly, regional and category analysis.
OBJ-03	Identify high-value and inactive customers.	Customer segmentation logic approved by Marketing.
OBJ-04	Improve return analysis.	Return rate available by product/category/region.
OBJ-05	Reduce manual reporting effort.	Recurring management report produced from standardized data.

6. Proposed Solution

Define and implement a business-approved analytics workflow that consolidates relevant sales, order, customer, product, region, and return information. The target reporting layer will provide role-based views and agreed KPIs for Sales, Marketing, Operations, Finance, and executive management.

The Business Analyst will establish the business definitions and acceptance criteria; the data/BI team will design the technical model and dashboard; business stakeholders will validate outputs during UAT.

7. Scope

7.1 In Scope

- Sales and order performance analysis.
- Customer activity and segmentation requirements.
- Product and category performance.
- Regional performance analysis.
- Product return analysis.
- KPI definitions and dashboard requirements.
- AS-IS and TO-BE reporting process analysis.
- Business rules and data validation requirements.
- User stories and acceptance criteria.
- UAT planning and business sign-off.

7.2 Out of Scope

- Redesign of the customer-facing e-commerce website.
- Replacement of the payment gateway.
- Warehouse hardware or logistics infrastructure changes.
- Changes to pricing strategy beyond analytics recommendations.
- Production data migration outside the agreed analytics scope.

8. Stakeholders & Responsibilities

Stakeholder	Interest / Responsibility
Project Sponsor	Funding, strategic direction, escalation and final approval.
Business Owner – Sales	Defines sales priorities and validates sales KPIs.
Marketing Manager	Defines segmentation and campaign-analysis requirements.
Operations Manager	Validates order and return process requirements.
Finance Manager	Validates revenue and financial metric definitions.
Product Manager	Provides product/category requirements and priorities.
BI / Data Team	Data model, transformation, dashboard development and technical validation.
QA / UAT Team	Test planning, defect management and evidence.
Business Analyst	Elicitation, analysis, documentation, traceability, stakeholder alignment and UAT coordination.

9. High-Level Business Requirements

ID	Requirement
BR-001	Management shall be able to view total revenue, orders, customers and return metrics for a selected period.
BR-002	Users shall be able to analyze sales by region, product category and product.
BR-003	Marketing shall be able to identify customer segments based on agreed business rules.
BR-004	The solution shall provide a standardized definition for each approved KPI.
BR-005	Users shall be able to compare current performance with prior periods.
BR-006	Return performance shall be available by product, category and region.
BR-007	Business users shall be able to export approved analytical results for further analysis.
BR-008	Data quality exceptions shall be identified and documented before business reporting.

10. KPI Catalogue – Initial Baseline

KPI	Business Definition
Total Revenue	Total recognized sales value for completed/approved orders within the selected period.
Total Orders	Count of valid customer orders within the selected period.
Average Order Value (AOV)	Total Revenue divided by Total Orders.
Repeat Customer Rate	Percentage of customers who placed more than one qualifying order in the measurement period.
Return Rate	Returned units or orders divided by the corresponding total units or orders, based on the approved reporting period.
Customer Churn / Inactivity	Customers meeting the agreed inactivity threshold; threshold to be finalized with Marketing.
Revenue Growth	Percentage change in revenue versus the approved comparison period.

11. Business Rules – Initial

- Only valid/approved orders are included in official sales reporting.

- Cancelled orders are excluded from revenue unless Finance approves an alternate treatment.
- Refunded or returned transactions must follow the agreed revenue and return treatment.
- Customer segmentation rules must be approved by Marketing before implementation.
- All KPI calculations must use a single approved definition across dashboards and reports.
- Any material data-quality exception must be logged and communicated to the business owner before sign-off.

12. AS-IS Reporting Process – High Level

Current state: operational systems → individual extracts/reports → manual Excel consolidation → stakeholder-specific calculations → management report → manual clarification/rework.

Key pain points: duplicate calculations, inconsistent KPI definitions, manual reconciliation, limited drill-down, and delayed reporting.

13. TO-BE Reporting Process – High Level

Target state: source systems → validated data layer → standardized business rules → KPI calculation layer → role-based dashboard → business review → approved decision/action.

The target process introduces a controlled KPI catalogue, data validation checkpoints, documented ownership, and a defined UAT/sign-off process.

14. Assumptions

- Required sales, customer, product and order data is available and can be accessed by the project team.
- Business stakeholders will provide timely clarification and validation.
- Existing source systems remain available during the project.
- Power BI or an equivalent BI platform is available for the analytical dashboard.
- The project will initially focus on agreed historical and current-period data.

15. Constraints

- Data quality may vary between source systems.
- Some customer attributes may be incomplete or inconsistent.
- The initial release has a fixed delivery window.
- Dashboard requirements may change as stakeholders review prototypes.
- Access to production data may be restricted.

16. Key Risks & Mitigation

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Conflicting KPI definitions	High	Create KPI catalogue and obtain business approval before build.
Poor source-data quality	High	Perform profiling, reconciliation and data-quality checks.
Late stakeholder feedback	Medium	Set review dates and named approvers.
Scope expansion	High	Use change-request process and impact assessment.
UAT defects near release	Medium	Prepare UAT scenarios early and conduct incremental validation.

17. Delivery Approach

A hybrid Agile delivery approach will be used. Requirements will be baselined at the appropriate level, while dashboard prototypes and analytical outputs will be reviewed iteratively with business stakeholders.

- Discovery and stakeholder workshops.
- Current-state analysis and data understanding.
- BRD/FRD and KPI catalogue baseline.
- User stories and acceptance criteria.
- Data analysis and dashboard prototype.
- Business review and requirement clarification.
- UAT execution and defect resolution.
- Business sign-off and transition to operational reporting.

18. High-Level Deliverables

Deliverable	Owner
Project Charter & Business Case	Business Analyst / Sponsor
Stakeholder Analysis & RACI	Business Analyst
Requirement Elicitation Pack	Business Analyst
BRD	Business Analyst
FRD / Functional Specification	Business Analyst + IT/BI
AS-IS / TO-BE Process Maps	Business Analyst
Gap & Impact Analysis	Business Analyst
User Stories & Acceptance Criteria	Business Analyst / Product Owner
Requirements Traceability Matrix	Business Analyst
SQL / Excel Analysis	BA / Data Analyst
Power BI Dashboard Requirements & Prototype	BA / BI Team
UAT Test Cases & Sign-off	BA / Business Users
Final Recommendations	Business Analyst

19. Success Criteria

- Business stakeholders approve the BRD, KPI catalogue, and target reporting process.
- Dashboard outputs reconcile to approved source data within agreed tolerance.
- UAT critical/high defects are resolved or formally accepted before release.
- Business users can independently interpret the agreed KPI definitions.
- The reporting process reduces manual consolidation and recurring clarification.

20. Business Benefits

Benefit	Expected Value
Faster reporting	Reduced manual consolidation and recurring report preparation.
Better decision-making	Common KPIs and consistent management visibility.
Customer retention insight	Earlier identification of inactive/high-value customer groups.
Return visibility	Improved identification of categories/products with elevated return rates.
Scalability	Reusable KPI and data definitions for future analytics initiatives.

21. Approval

Role	Name / Sign-off	Date
Project Sponsor	_____	13-Jan-2023
Business Owner	_____	13-Jan-2023
Lead Business Analyst	_____	13-Jan-2023

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